

How to Use or Adapt *Convalescent Snakes & Ladders*

This guide explains how to view, copy, or adapt the *Convalescent Snakes & Ladders* project using GitHub. No programming experience is required.

1. What You Need Before You Start

- A web browser (Chrome, Safari, Edge, etc.)
- A free GitHub account
(create one at <https://github.com> — this takes about 2 minutes)

You do **not** need to install software or understand coding.

2. Viewing the Project (No Account Needed)

You can view and interact with the project here:

👉 <https://alice-van-rooyen.github.io/snakesandladders/>

This version is read-only and suitable for demonstration or teaching.

3. Making Your Own Copy (Forking the Project)

If you want to **adapt**, **edit**, or **experiment** with the project, you need your own copy.

Step-by-step:

1. Go to the project page on GitHub
(e.g. <https://github.com/alice-van-rooyen/snakesandladders>)
2. In the top-right corner, click **Fork**
3. Choose your own account when prompted

That's it — GitHub creates a personal copy of the entire project under your account.

You now have:

- Your own editable version
 - No risk of affecting the original
 - Full freedom to experiment
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4. Making Changes (No Coding Required)

Once you've forked the project:

1. Click into your copy of the repository
2. Navigate to the `data/` folder

3. Click on files such as:
 - text.json
 - help.json
 - jumps.json
4. Click the  **Edit** button
5. Make changes directly in the browser
6. Click **Commit changes** at the bottom

Your version updates instantly.

5. Publishing Your Version

Your fork can be made public as a live website:

1. Go to **Settings → Pages**
2. Under “Source”, choose:
 - Branch: main
 - Folder: /root
3. Save

GitHub will give you a public link you can share.

6. Attribution

If you adapt or reuse this project, please include the following somewhere visible (e.g. README, help screen):

© Alice van Rooyen, 2026.

Originally developed as *Convalescent Snakes & Ladders*.

Used under CC BY 4.0.

This protects academic attribution and helps others trace the work.

7. What You Don’t Need to Worry About

- You cannot “break” the original project if you are working on your forked copy
 - You don’t need to understand the code to use it
 - You don’t need permission to experiment
 - You don’t need to publish anything publicly unless you choose to
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8. If you need help

You can reach out to the original author at amvvanrooyen@hotmail.co.uk.